# Group 27 Progress Report: Early-Game Win Prediction in League of Legends

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## 1 Introduction

League of Legends matches can change direction after an early lead. Gold, experience and combat statistics reveal advantages, but the eventual outcome also depends on decisions and interactions that a team-level snapshot does not capture. Our project predicts the probability of an eventual blue-team win from statistics published for the ten-minute checkpoint. Each match has one binary target: `blueWins=1` for a blue victory and 0 for a red victory. The intended application is historical match analysis, rather than a claim that a game is already decided at ten minutes.

Our proposal considered logistic regression, support vector machines (SVMs), tree ensembles and neural networks. For this milestone we implement a controlled comparison of simple baselines, regularized logistic regression and random forests. We ask whether objectives and vision statistics improve on economy, experience, farming and combat features, and whether nonlinear interactions improve on the linear model. We evaluate probability error as well as classification performance.

We present completed data checks, fixed match splits, five logistic feature configurations, two random forests and preliminary validation results. The final test set remains reserved. The contribution is a transparent feature-group and model-family comparison with explicit uncertainty and data limitations.

## 2 Related Work

Junior and Campelo (2023) compare methods across stages of League matches and report that logistic regression and gradient boosting are useful early-game approaches. Their checkpoints depend on the percentage of eventual game duration, whereas ours is a fixed published ten-minute snapshot. These different settings prevent a direct leaderboard comparison. Their work motivates retaining a simple linear model and examining which information is available at the prediction checkpoint.

Kim et al. (2020) address confidence calibration for League winner prediction, emphasizing uncertainty in game outcomes. This is relevant to our probability output: a model that predicts the correct class can still give misleading confidence. We use their work to motivate probability evaluation, without reproducing their uncertainty-aware neural loss. Guo et al. (2017) study calibration in neural networks and investigate temperature scaling. Their experiments concern different data, so they motivate a future calibration comparison rather than establish that our current model needs that particular correction.

Silva et al. (2018) study recurrent networks for continuous prediction of competitive League matches. Their sequential formulation motivates investigating how an advantage develops, but our current experiment uses one fixed checkpoint. Do et al. (2021) use player–champion experience to predict ranked outcomes before gameplay. Their work motivates richer player/champion context, which the present CSV omits; its pre-game task and feature set are not directly comparable to our validation scores.

Niculescu-Mizil and Caruana (2005) support evaluating probability quality separately from accuracy and ranking. We report Brier score, log loss and reliability diagrams without a fitted post-processing calibrator. Breiman (2001) motivates our implemented random-forest comparison, which can represent nonlinear interactions. The dataset is cited separately (Ma, 2020).

## 3 Dataset

### 3.1 Source and contents

We use Yi Lan Ma's *League of Legends Diamond Ranked Games (10 min)*, Version 1 (Ma, 2020).

| Training feature | Mean | Std. dev. |
|---|---|---|
| Gold difference | -0.78 | 2431.96 |
| XP difference | -53.66 | 1907.12 |
| Kill difference | 0.02 | 4.15 |
| Wards placed difference | -0.09 | 26.04 |

Table 1: Selected blue-minus-red features in the 6,915 training matches, before scaling. The complete eleven-feature summary is included with the results. Means near zero are consistent with roughly balanced sides; the large ward-count spread warrants inspection.

The uploader attributes the data to Riot's API and describes ranked solo-queue games from high Diamond I to Master. We treat that rank description as source documentation, since the CSV does not independently encode the players' ranks. Each row contains both teams' statistics and the final outcome. The label is provided by the match result; we performed no manual annotation.

Our copy contains 9,879 distinct match IDs and 40 columns: 38 source predictors, `gameId`, and `blueWins`. There are 4,930 blue wins (49.90%) and 4,949 red wins (50.10%). Checks found zero missing cells, duplicate match IDs, or duplicate complete predictor rows. No source column is constant. The included CSV is approximately 1.45 MB, and its SHA-256 hash is recorded with the experiment outputs so the results can be tied to the exact file.

### 3.2 Checks and preprocessing

We verified that the supplied gold and XP differences equal blue totals minus red totals. Blue kills equal red deaths and vice versa. For both teams, gold per minute and lane CS per minute equal the corresponding total divided by ten. These identities guide a compact representation rather than retaining redundant copies of the same information. We do not treat the numerical match identifier as a predictor.

No rows were removed, imputed, clipped or augmented. We inspected training-feature distributions and recorded counts beyond three training standard deviations. Some vision values are unusually large, but their source-level validity is unknown. We retain them provisionally rather than impose an unverified exclusion rule, and identify vision quality as a limitation. Logistic scaling is fitted using training rows only; forests use unscaled inputs.

### 3.3 Provenance, use and limitations

The release lacks dates, region, patch versions and player identifiers. We therefore cannot verify chronological generalization, prevent overlap between players across splits, or establish that the model applies to the current game. The uploader supplies a ten-minute description, but the CSV does not expose raw timeline timestamps for independent checkpoint verification. No post-match statistic is intentionally added as an input; final outcome is used only as the target.

For the TA's data-use question, the publisher lists CC0 (Ma, 2020). Riot's API terms permit documented purposes, and its Developer Portal explicitly lists personal research as acceptable (Riot Games, 2013, 2026). We interpret our offline, non-commercial statistical study as research within that allowance. This is a documented policy basis, not project-specific approval or a blanket license for every ML application; neither cited document expressly addresses model training. The report uses the static aggregate CSV, with no player identifiers or live-game assistance. The uploader's licensing authority is not independently verified. Separate API feasibility data are not used in these models.

## 4 Features

For each selected quantity $q$, we construct $d_q = q_{\text{blue}} - q_{\text{red}}$. The seven core inputs are differences in total gold, total XP, average level, lane minions killed, jungle minions killed, kills and assists. They summarize relative economy, progression, farming and combat. A positive gold difference, for example, means blue has more gold. We omit the deaths difference because it is determined by kills, and omit fixed-time rate columns that repeat totals. We also avoid including both team totals together with their exact difference in this initial representation.

The objective extension adds dragon and Rift Herald count differences. The vision extension adds wards placed and wards destroyed differences. The resulting configurations have one feature for gold alone, seven for core, nine for core plus either extension, and eleven for both. We compare objectives and vision separately as well as jointly so a gain in the combined set is not automatically attributed to both groups. These choices are based on the proposed feature families and known redundancy, not a search over validation-driven subsets.

Differences discard some absolute-state information. Two matches with the same gold lead

can have different total economies, which may affect the meaning of that lead. This is a tradeoff for a smaller, interpretable initial experiment, and comparing side totals remains future work. All selected inputs are numerical, so we do not learn embeddings or add one-hot champion/item encodings. Gold, XP and level remain correlated even after exact duplicates are removed; individual coefficients should not be interpreted as independent causal effects.

# 5 Implementation

## 5.1 Baselines and logistic regression

The majority baseline learns the more common training label and predicts it for every validation match. Because the training set has 3,464 red wins and 3,451 blue wins, it always predicts red. A separate probability baseline outputs the training blue-win frequency, $3451/6915 = 0.49906$, for every match. Keeping these baselines separate avoids presenting hard majority predictions as meaningful confidence estimates.

Gold-only logistic regression tests how much one obvious advantage explains. The core logistic model then tests whether the additional economy/combat quantities help. Three further logistic fits use core plus objectives, core plus vision, and core plus both. Every fit uses the same training and validation match IDs and the same optimization settings. Thus the feature comparisons change the representation while holding the model family and observations fixed.

For a standardized input vector $z_i$, logistic regression predicts

$$p_i = \frac{1}{1 + \exp[-(b + w^\top z_i)]}. \tag{1}$$

With equally weighted training matches, the scikit-learn L2 objective is

$$J(w,b) = -\frac{1}{n}\sum_{i=1}^{n}\big[y_i \log p_i + (1-y_i)\log(1-p_i)\big] + \frac{\|w\|_2^2}{2nC}. \tag{2}$$

The intercept is not penalized. We set $C = 1$ and optimize with L-BFGS, a limited-memory quasi-Newton method (scikit-learn developers, 2025). This is a change from the proposal's mini-batch SGD suggestion: the small dense feature set permits a standard deterministic solver without selecting a learning-rate schedule. We use tolerance $10^{-6}$ and at most 2,000 iterations. The five fits converged without convergence warnings in 7–22 iterations. No hyperparameter search, class weighting or threshold tuning has been performed.

## 5.2 Random forests

We fit one forest on the seven core inputs and another on the eleven expanded inputs, preserving the logistic split and validation match order. Each uses 500 bootstrap trees, maximum depth 8, minimum 10 samples per leaf, square-root feature subsampling, Gini impurity and seed 42. These settings were fixed before inspecting forest scores; no search was conducted. Depth and leaf-size constraints limit complexity, although this is not an optimized forest configuration.

Trees learn threshold splits by greedily reducing Gini impurity; there is no gradient-based optimization of the logistic objective. The forest probability is the average of its trees' leaf class proportions. Inputs are unscaled differences, since threshold splits do not require standardization. This tests whether nonlinear interactions help while holding the feature representation and observed matches fixed.

## 5.3 Reproducible pipeline

Each logistic estimator is a `StandardScaler` followed by `LogisticRegression`. Feature means and population standard deviations are learned only from training rows; validation rows use that transformation. Scaling controls the effect of feature units on the L2 penalty. Both model families use a fixed probability threshold of 0.5 for blue-win predictions.

The implementation saves the source hash, split assignments, feature lists, model settings, versions, diagnostics and validation predictions. Packages are pandas 2.2.3, NumPy 2.0.2, scikit-learn 1.6.1 and Matplotlib 3.9.3, under Python 3.12.14. Scripts reproduce both model families and independently verify saved metrics; the notebook explains the steps. Saved splits are reused. There is no test-performance evaluation step.

# 6 Results and Evaluation

## 6.1 Protocol and metrics

We split matches with stratification and random seed 42 into 6,915 training, 1,482 validation and

1,482 test matches (approximately 70/15/15). The validation labels contain 740 blue and 742 red wins. Stratification preserves near balance without over/undersampling. Global structural checks and class counts describe the dataset, while all learned preprocessing and fitted probabilities use training data only. Random splitting is a practical limitation of the available metadata, not evidence of chronological independence.

All reported scores are preliminary validation results; the test set is reserved for the final evaluation after model selection. We have not used cross-validation yet. Accuracy, precision, recall and F1 describe thresholded predictions, with blue as the positive class. ROC-AUC describes probability ranking. Brier score is $n^{-1}\sum_i (p_i - y_i)^2$, and log loss is mean unregularized binary cross-entropy on held-out matches. Lower values are better for both probability errors. Precision is reported as zero under the explicit zero-division convention when a model predicts no blue wins. The class-only majority row has no probability metrics.

### 6.2 Preliminary findings

Table 2 shows that gold alone reaches 71.05% accuracy, compared with 50.07% for the majority baseline. The seven-feature core improves to 71.93%. Adding objectives reaches 72.27%, with validation log loss 0.53969 versus 0.54331 for core. Adding vision alone leaves accuracy unchanged and slightly worsens probability error. The combined extension obtains 72.13% accuracy and log loss 0.53990. On this split, objectives appear more useful than the two vision counts, but this is a small difference among closely related models, not a definitive ranking.

The combined extension correctly classifies 1,069 matches, versus 1,066 for core: three additional correct decisions overall. Its confusion matrix contains 518 correctly predicted red wins, 551 correctly predicted blue wins, 224 false blue predictions and 189 missed blue wins. The core model has 219 false blue predictions and 197 missed blue wins. The extension therefore changes the error balance rather than improving every category.

The core and expanded forests reach 71.79% and 71.86% accuracy, versus 71.93% and 72.13% for matched logistic models. Expanded forest log loss is 0.54012 versus 0.53990 for expanded logistic regression. Thus the tested forest provides no clear gain. Paired-bootstrap accuracy intervals for forest minus logistic are $[-1.08, 0.74]$ percentage points on core and $[-1.28, 0.74]$ on expanded inputs. Both include zero; these results do not rule out gains from future tuning or other representations.

We estimated uncertainty for the planned combined-extension minus core contrast by resampling validation matches in pairs 2,000 times (seed 42), keeping each match's predictions together. The accuracy difference is +0.20 percentage points, with a percentile 95% interval of $[-1.21, 1.69]$ points. The log-loss difference is $-0.00342$, with interval $[-0.00980, 0.00291]$, and the Brier difference is $-0.00078$, with interval $[-0.00339, 0.00188]$. All include zero. These conditional intervals hold the fitted models fixed; they do not account for training/split variability, possible player dependence, or inspecting multiple comparisons.

Figure 1 shows predictions distributed across the probability range and broadly following the reliability diagonal, with visible deviations. Binning can hide local errors and sparse-bin uncertainty, so we do not describe the probabilities as fully calibrated. Gold-only already captures much of the signal; the current linear representation leaves limited incremental improvement from the added groups. This does not show that vision is unimportant in the game or would remain unhelpful under better measurements or a nonlinear model.

## 7 Feedback and Plans

Hongyi Zhang's October 9 Teams feedback requested a formal dataset citation, feature/sample/class statistics, evidence concerning training use, simple baselines and a clear system strategy. We provide the citation, checked counts and Table 1, cite Riot's documented research allowance alongside the CC0 listing, and implement majority/probability/gold-only baselines plus logistic/forest comparisons. The proposal feedback also requested reasons for SVM/NN choices and flagged a nested ZIP. We now distinguish implemented models from planned alternatives, and package ordinary report/code/data files in one archive.

An RBF SVM could capture nonlinear boundaries among the small standardized inputs, but its decision scores require a separately assessed probability-estimation procedure. A small neural network could learn economy/objective interactions, with overfitting and calibration risks on this

| Model | Inputs | Acc. | Prec. | Recall | F1 | AUC | Brier | Log loss |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Majority class | 0 | 0.5007 | 0.0000 | 0.0000 | 0.0000 | – | – | – |
| Training win rate | 0 | 0.5007 | 0.0000 | 0.0000 | 0.0000 | 0.5000 | 0.2500 | 0.6931 |
| Gold-only LR | 1 | 0.7105 | 0.7043 | 0.7243 | 0.7142 | 0.7926 | 0.1861 | 0.5496 |
| Core LR | 7 | 0.7193 | 0.7126 | 0.7338 | 0.7230 | 0.7985 | 0.1836 | 0.5433 |
| Core + objectives LR | 9 | 0.7227 | 0.7123 | 0.7459 | 0.7287 | 0.8006 | 0.1828 | 0.5397 |
| Core + vision LR | 9 | 0.7193 | 0.7126 | 0.7338 | 0.7230 | 0.7984 | 0.1836 | 0.5434 |
| Core + objectives + vision LR | 11 | 0.7213 | 0.7110 | 0.7446 | 0.7274 | 0.8004 | 0.1828 | 0.5399 |
| Core RF | 7 | 0.7179 | 0.7048 | 0.7486 | 0.7261 | 0.7965 | 0.1844 | 0.5457 |
| Core + objectives + vision RF | 11 | 0.7186 | 0.7073 | 0.7446 | 0.7255 | 0.8004 | 0.1828 | 0.5401 |

Table 2: Preliminary validation results on the same 1,482 matches. LR is L2 logistic regression; RF is random forest. Blue is the positive class. Lower Brier and log loss are better. Probability baseline scores use the training win rate. No test scores are reported.

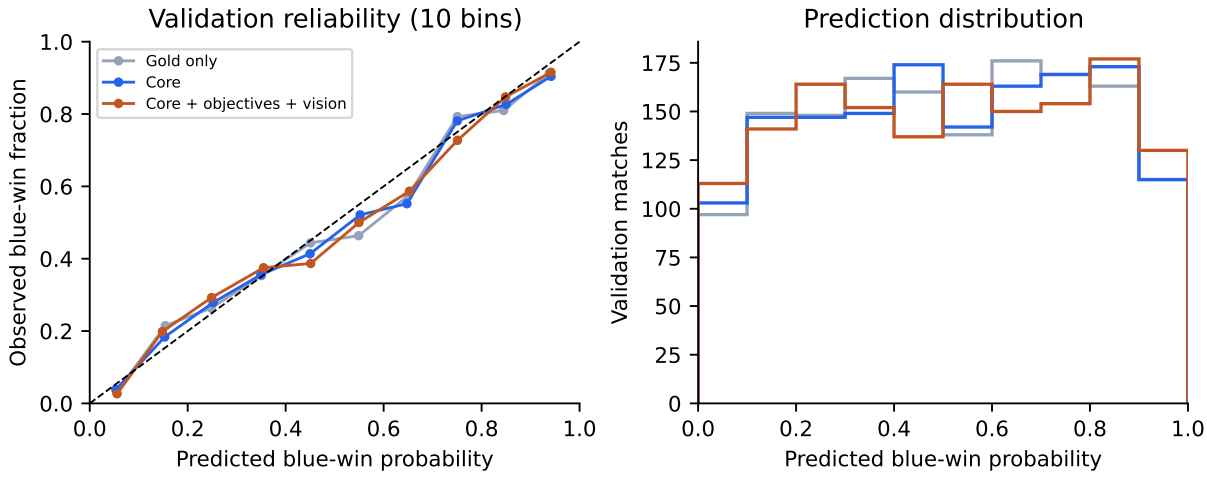



Figure 1: Validation reliability and predicted-probability distributions for gold-only, core and combined-extension logistic models. Reliability points aggregate ten equal-width bins; the diagonal indicates agreement of predicted and observed blue-win frequencies. These descriptive plots have sampling noise and do not establish perfect calibration.

modest dataset. Our implemented forest supplies an initial nonlinear reference (Breiman, 2001); its similar scores show why extra complexity must be tested rather than assumed beneficial.

The results change our priorities: gold-only is strong, feature gains are small, and the forest offers no clear advantage. We will emphasize stable comparisons and error analysis. The weak logistic vision result warrants checking measurement quality and representation before dropping vision permanently; it does not establish that vision is unimportant in League.

**Dated responsibilities.** By **November 17**, Peter will compare regularization and forest complexity with training-only stratified cross-validation. By **November 24**, Savvy will examine feature representations and vision quality, documenting the separate fresh-data extension. By **December 1**, Krish will lead calibration/error analysis and assemble limitations, using training folds for any calibrator. By **December 7**, all three will review and freeze choices; Peter will run the final held-out evaluation once and Savvy will verify reproducibility. By **December 10**, Krish will assemble the final report, Savvy will check the package, and Peter will audit reported results. All members will review the submission.

Repeated consultation of validation results can make conclusions optimistic, so this split remains developmental. Fresh API collection and champion/item features are a separate extension; the core historical-data evaluation remains reproducible without them. Missing player IDs continue to limit dependence checks.

## Team Contributions

**Savvy Liu** implemented the preprocessing, logistic/forest experiments and evaluation checks, and prepared this report with the AI assistance disclosed below. Savvy also contributed to the original proposal as part of the three-way split. **Peter Li** contributed to the original proposal as part of the

three-way split, reviewed the progress-report work and approved it. **Krish Panchal** contributed to the original proposal as part of the three-way split, reviewed the progress-report work and approved it.

## Generative AI Disclosure

We used OpenAI Codex, with session-recorded model `gpt-6.1-sol`, for source retrieval, planning, code generation, debugging, interpretation and report drafting. We also considered an AI review supplied to the team. Results were produced by executing the included code locally and were checked for reproducibility. For the recorded project chat through the November 10 policy check, we counted **22 user queries**, including clarification responses. Applying the syllabus convention gives $22 \times 4.32 = 95.04$ **g** $\mathbf{CO_2}$. This is a query-based approximation covering that chat, including repository and API-setup discussion, not a measured inference footprint or an estimate of unobserved external-review activity. Provider: OpenAI. Hosted hardware, inference time and compute region were not exposed; local experiment runtimes are not substituted for those values.

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